

Incident Response Guide

NovaBridge Technologies Inc. | Last revised: January 5, 2026 | Owner: IT Security Team

1. Purpose

This guide defines how NovaBridge Technologies Inc. detects, reports, and responds to information security incidents, to minimize impact and restore normal operations quickly and safely.

2. What Counts as an Incident

- Suspected or confirmed unauthorized access to Company systems or data.
- Malware, ransomware, or suspicious activity detected on a device.
- Lost or stolen devices containing Company data.
- Phishing emails that were clicked or that resulted in credential entry.
- Any exposure of Confidential or Restricted data, per the IT Security Policy classification.

3. Severity Levels

- SEV-1 (Critical): Active breach, ransomware, or exposure of customer data. Immediate response required.
- SEV-2 (High): Compromised single account, malware contained to one device. Response within 4 hours.
- SEV-3 (Medium): Suspicious activity without confirmed compromise. Response within 1 business day.
- SEV-4 (Low): Policy violations without security impact. Reviewed in regular security review.

4. Reporting an Incident

1. Report immediately to security@novabridge.example or the #security-incidents Slack channel.
2. Include what happened, when it was noticed, which systems or accounts are affected, and any actions already taken.
3. Do not attempt to investigate, "clean up," or power off an affected device yourself — this can destroy evidence needed for investigation.
4. Disconnect the affected device from the network (unplug ethernet or disable Wi-Fi) if instructed by IT Security, but leave it powered on.

5. Incident Response Process

1. Detection & Reporting — incident is identified and reported to IT Security.

2. Triage & Containment — IT Security assesses severity and isolates affected systems to prevent spread.
3. Investigation — root cause and scope of impact are determined.
4. Eradication & Recovery — threat is removed, systems are restored from clean backups if needed, and access is re-verified.
5. Post-Incident Review — a blameless review is conducted within 5 business days of resolution for SEV-1 and SEV-2 incidents, documenting root cause and follow-up actions.

6. Roles and Responsibilities

- All Employees: Report suspected incidents promptly; do not attempt independent remediation.
- IT Security Team: Lead triage, containment, investigation, and recovery.
- People Operations: Coordinate communication if an incident involves employee or customer personal data.
- Legal: Assess regulatory notification obligations for data breaches involving personal data.

7. Communication

During an active SEV-1 or SEV-2 incident, IT Security will provide status updates at least every 2 hours via the #security-incidents channel until resolution. External communication (customers, regulators, press) is coordinated exclusively through Legal and the executive team.

8. Related Documents

- IT Security Policy
- Password Policy
- Device Policy
- VPN Documentation